

Imagine a world in which students don't know how to write their own essays, Designers don't understand their own illustrations, and Architects don't design their own buildings. I've noticed a loss of skill in certain tasks due to using shortcuts, such as artificial intelligence. For example, I struggled to write this essay without using artificial intelligence (I used artificial intelligence to help create an outline for this essay). In this essay, I want to explore and organize some of my thoughts and fears related to artificial intelligence affecting knowledge and industry. Part of those fears is that artificial intelligence will become advanced enough to produce high-quality designs without human interaction from a designer, and that it will lead to a mass loss of collective design knowledge as the job becomes less lucrative.

People learn and grow through repetition and failure. Nobody is born with innate talent and perfect judgment; those things are grown out of practice and passion. When artificial tools automate judgment they don't just save time, they remove the need for these skill sets. Our current society is too focused on the end product. It's very much a cheap quantity over expensive quality. Oftentimes, the value of taking things slow and meticulous, creating with care, is overlooked for a cheaper, faster alternative, which recently means using artificial intelligence over human work. Using artificial intelligence to speed up design processes doesn't just transform the role of the designer, but completely removes the need for certain skill sets that designers have developed over time. Slowly, our collective knowledge shrinks, and we become less and less self-reliant.

learning the hard way

By Benjamin Smith

I'm sure that many will argue that the rising popularity of artificial intelligence tools leads to an increase in collective knowledge because we now have LLMs that can pretty much answer any question we have. It's basically Google trained to have a conversation. The problem is that it removes the need for individual knowledge. If everyone's answer to a question is let me ChatGPT it overtime we will forget how to ask the question. In addition, the great thing about Google is that all the information was created by a human at some point. Artificial Intelligence now mostly paraphrases data its collected from Google written by a human, but I'm curious how that might change with the addition of artificial intelligence in every field.

The irony is not lost on me that the arguments I made in this essay are close to, if not the exact same as, those who argued against the creation of Photoshop and Illustrator, the invention of the linotype, or even the invention of the printing press. I'm all for artificial intelligence making programs and tools more efficient, but I don't like it when I know I'm looking at artificial intelligence. To me, that is bad design, and it stands out to me similarly to a design mistake in a poster. Artificial intelligence-produced art has a lot of potential when prompted by a talented designer who uses it more as a collaborative tool than a replacement. I just have a healthy mistrust of the intentions of those who are creating and investing massive amounts of money into this technology.

